

Sanctification



A man pulls a clean robe over a stained shirt, and he is glad to do it. He is not hiding. He is dressing for a new identity that is already his.

Before you gather

- Read Day 27, Sanctification, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read Colossians 3:1–4, 12–14 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.
- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.

- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 · ICEBREAKER · 7 MIN

Open the room

What is a piece of clothing, a uniform, or a jacket that changed how you carried yourself when you put it on?

Leader. Identity you wear. Do not ask them to list unholy things to take off. That was the journal response. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 · THE WORD · 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: Sanctification is both a status and a direction. God has already set His people apart — washed, sanctified, justified — and He is still clothing them in a new way of life. The robe is not a costume to impress strangers. It is who they now are.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

Sanctification means God has set you apart as holy and His, and now He is making you more like Jesus.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Greek hagiasmos — holiness, consecration, being set apart as God's.

MEMORY VERSE · 1 CORINTHIANS 6:11

And such were some of you. But you were washed, you were sanctified, you were justified in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ and by the Spirit of our God.

Together, open the flashcard for Sanctification. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

Colossians 3:1–4, 12–14

Paul starts with “you have been raised,” then tells them what to put on. The devotion asked them to define positional and progressive sanctification and to commit to taking garments off. You will let the text show the order instead of quizzing the definitions.

If then you have been raised with Christ, seek the things that are above, where Christ is, seated at the right hand of God. Set your minds on things that are above, not on things that are on earth. For you have died, and your life is hidden with Christ in God. When Christ who is your life appears, then you also will appear with him in glory. Put on then, as God’s chosen ones, holy and beloved, compassionate hearts, kindness, humility, meekness, and patience, bearing with one another... And above all these put on love, which binds everything together in perfect harmony.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. What does Paul say is already true of them before he tells them to put anything on?

CORE

Leader. Raised with Christ, died, life hidden with Christ, chosen, holy, beloved. The command lands on people who already have a status. Imperative follows indicative.

2. Look at the wardrobe list in verses 12–14. Are these mostly private feelings, or ways of treating other people?

Leader. Mostly relational: compassion, patience, bearing with, forgiving, love. Holiness shows up in the room, not only in a quiet time.

4 · AROUND THE ROOM · 20 MIN

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. 1 Corinthians 6:11 puts washed, sanctified, and justified in the past tense — “such were some of you.” How should a Christian’s past be talked about: erased from honesty, or no longer in charge? CORE

Leader. Paul names the past in the previous verses and then says “were.” Honesty without ownership. The old life is not the name on the robe.

4. Philippians 2:12–13: work out your salvation, for God is at work in you to will and to work. Where do we slide into “God does it, so I will not” or “I do it, so it depends on me”?

Leader. Both slides deny the verse. We work because He works. Effort is not earning. Passivity is not faith.

5. Colossians 3:4 says Christ is your life, and glory is still future. What would change this month if you believed holiness is becoming who you already are in Him, rather than becoming someone God might finally like?

Leader. Fear-based change exhausts people. Identity-based change can tell the truth and still rejoice. Tie back to adoption and justification without reteaching them.

5 • SAY IT • 5 MIN

In one sentence

Sanctification means God has already set you apart as His, and He is making you more like Jesus.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 • THIS WEEK • 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Let someone who does not follow Jesus see you in the middle of being changed. Apologize where you are still rough. Serve where you are

growing. Tell them God has already set His people apart, and He is making them like Jesus — His work, and unfinished on purpose.

Leader. An honest unfinished place will preach more than a victory story. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

7 • PRAY • 8 MIN

Leave silence between these

1. Thank God that “holy and beloved” is already how He names His people.
2. Ask for one piece of the wardrobe — name it — to be put on this week toward a real person.
3. Ask Him to keep working in you so your effort is not a panic.

Before you stumble

Part IV ends here. Two errors: the Christian who hears “already holy” and stops fighting sin, and the Christian who hears “become holy” and lives condemned. First Corinthians 6:11 will not support either. Progress is real and uneven. Do not promise a personality transplant by next month. Do not call stubborn sin “just your wiring” if the passage names it as something to put away (Colossians 3:5–9, if you need the put-off list without making people share it).

WITH STUDENTS

Ask what team gear does to how they play. Then ask what it would mean to practice as someone already on the roster, not as someone auditioning every day.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

Romans 6:11–14. Consider yourselves dead to sin and alive to God; do not let sin reign. A strong second text if the group wants the fight described more clearly.